under audit are called as Audit Working Papers. Working papers provide the basis of conclusions and summarizations of the report prepared by the auditor at the end of the audit work. As per SA-230 "Audit Documentation" audit working paper refers to the documents prepared or obtained by the auditor and retained by him in connection with the performance of his audit.

The term 'audit working paper' mean the written paper and document containing details about accounts which are under audit, analysis, summaries and comments built up by an auditor during the course of a particular audit engagement.

Thus, all the documents gathered or prepared by auditors during the course of an audit constitute audit working papers, but broadly these are two types:

- Working papers **prepared** by the auditor himself, like audit note book, audit program, details of queries made and their explanations thereof.
- Working papers **collected** by the auditor from the client, like schedule of debtors and creditors, management representations, confirmations etc.,

5.3.2 Definition

- **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India** defines audit working paper as, "working paper must include audit program, queries, explanations given for the queries, schedules for the important items like depreciation, inventories, confirmation from third parties, certificates issued by the management, banks,etc..".
- **Prof. Meigs**, "the term working paper is a comprehensive one and includes all the evidences gathered by the auditor to show the work he has done, the methods and procedures he has followed and the conclusions he has developed".

Guidelines of Audit Working Papers as specified in SA-230, Audit Documentation

Working Papers prepared or obtained by the auditor in connection with the performance of audit are the property of auditor and it is the duty of the auditor to retain and preserve the working papers for a period of 7 years.

- **According to A.W. Johnson**, "Audit working papers are written, private material which the auditor prepares for each audit. They describe the accounting information used, his conclusions (and reasons thereof) and the financial statements."

5.3.3 Contents of Audit Working Papers

The documents obtained in the conduct of audit constitute the audit working papers. The content of audit working papers varies depending on the type and scope of audit. Auditing and Assusrance Statndards (AAS 3) issued by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India states working papers should record the auditors plan, the nature, timing and extent of the audit procedure performed and the conclusions obtained from the evidence.

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